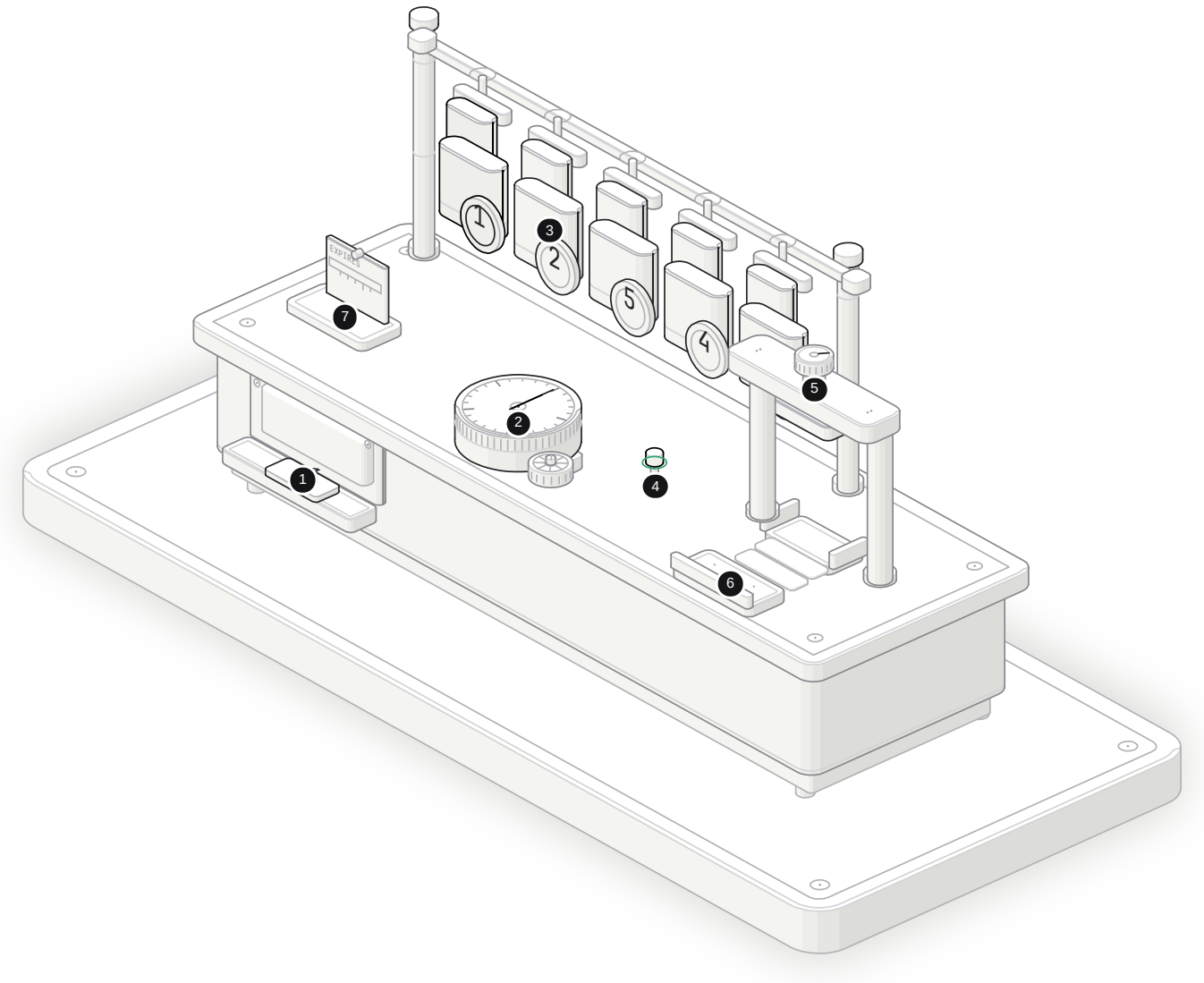
304



How does a response stay fresh without a cache to go stale?

Freshness is left to HTTP itself. A coat's tag is its ETag — a checksum of Modified and Length — so a ticket that still matches gets the very same ticket back as 304 Not Modified and the coat stays on the rail. A stale ticket brings the coat down and the press hands it out folded — brotli, gzip or zstd, whichever Accept-Encoding admits.

0 copies
NO SERVER-SIDE CONTENT CACHE, BY DESIGN

2 fields
IN THE ETAG CHECKSUM: MODIFIED + LENGTH

3 codecs
BROTLI, GZIP, ZSTD AGAINST ACCEPT-ENCODING

304 on match
SAME TICKET BACK, NO COAT DOWN ON THE RAIL

01 **The claim ticket**
If-None-Match, handed in at the counter.

02 **The comparator**
Two dials compared: the ticket against the coat's tag.

03 **A coat on the rail**
The representation, its tag the ETag — checksum of Modified + Length.

04 **The green lamp**
Tag matches: 304 Not Modified, no coat comes down.

05 **The press**
Brotli, gzip or zstd — the coat folded to what the client admits.

06 **The out tray**
The folded bundle handed over the counter.

07 **The Expires card**
How long a client may trust what it holds.